From: **Marc Weiss** mweiss@weblab.org
To: Rob Reuss robreuss@mac.com
Subject: 2nd of 2 /Anthropic Says Little Progress Made With Pentagon in Talks Over A.I. - The New York Times
Date: February 26, 2026 at 7:30 PM

https://www.nytimes.com/2026/02/26/technology/anthropic-pentagon-talks-ai.html

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Anthropic Says Little Progress Made With Pentagon in Talks Over A.I.

The Pentagon has imposed a Friday deadline over a demand that Anthropic provide unfettered access to its A.I. system without safeguards for military operations.

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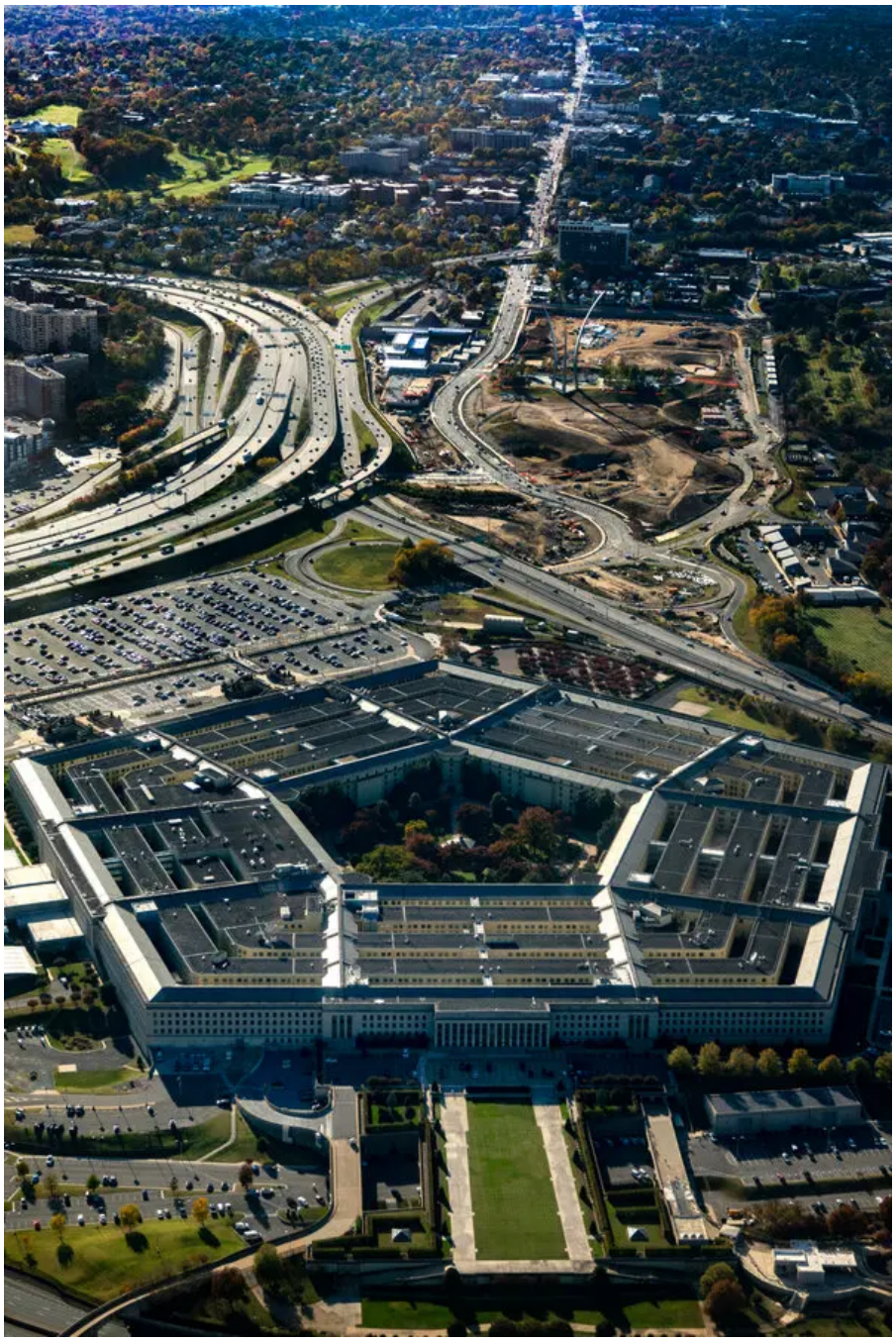

“We cannot in good conscience accede to their request,” Dario Amodei, chief executive of Anthropic, said in a statement. Kenny Holston/The New York Times

By Julian E. Barnes and Sheera Frenkel
Julian Barnes reported from Washington and Sheera Frenkel from San Francisco.

Feb. 26, 2026 Updated 6:53 p.m. ET

The Pentagon and the artificial in
continued their fight on Thursday
defense, a day before a deadline i
administration for the company t
technology to be applied broadly

The two sides are hurtling toward
over a Pentagon demand that Ant
access to its A.I. system without s
company, as part of the negotiatio
contract involving A.I. in classifie

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On Wednesday, the Pentagon gav
would not use the company's A.I.
surveillance of Americans or auto
which were the start-up's key con

But Anthropic said late Thursday
Pentagon fell short of what it was

"We cannot in good conscience ac
Amodei, Anthropic's chief executi
the Pentagon. "It is the Departme
contractors most aligned with the

contractors most aligned with the
substantial value that Anthropic's
armed forces, we hope they recon

On Wednesday, the Pentagon gave Anthropic assurances that it would not use the company's A.I. system, Claude, for mass surveillance of Americans or autonomous drone operations, which were the start-up's key concerns. Kelsey McClellan for The New York Times

If Anthropic does not comply, the
either invoke the Defense Procure
company to work with it on its ter
chain threat and block the firm fr

government. If the latter route is
intelligence agencies could be for
Claude, which has been the prima
classified systems.

On Thursday, Sean Parnell, the P
social media that the Pentagon ha
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for the two scenarios Anthropic h
But he reiterated that the Pentago
company allow the Pentagon to u
lawful purposes."

"This is a simple, common-sense
Anthropic from jeopardizing criti
potentially putting our warfighter
let ANY company dictate the term
operational decisions."

Emma Probasco, a senior fellow
Security and Emerging Technolog
Anthropic and the Pentagon was
need this deal to happen," she sai

The fight began last month when
Anthropic must allow its A.I. mod
purpose that the Defense Departr

But Anthropic officials argued tha
only to do certain things and wou
drones or other tasks. The San Fr
assurances that its technology wo

surveillance of Americans, provok

Anthropic had little time to review
Pentagon, a person briefed on the
new language appeared to addres
new offer still gave the Defense D
aside the restrictions when it saw

Mr. Amodei said that he believed deeply in using A.I. to defend the United States and other democracies. Bhawika Chhabra/Reuters

Anthropic employees have been q
over the line the company has set
Defense, two people at the compa
drawn to work at the company be
as valuing safety and more respon

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said.

In his statement, Mr. Amodei saic
using A.I. to defend the United St
The company was the first to depl
classified systems, he said.

“Claude is extensively deployed a
and other national security agenc
applications, such as intelligence
simulation, operational planning,
he said.

Mr. Amodei said while Anthropic
outside the limits of what “today’s
reliably do.”

As a result, the company insisted
technology for domestic surveilla
said.

Julian E. Barnes covers the U.S. intelligence agencies and international security matters for The Times. He has written about security issues for more than two decades.

Sheera Frenkel is a reporter based in the San Francisco Bay Area covering the ways technology affects everyday lives with a focus on social media companies, including Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, TikTok, YouTube, Telegram and WhatsApp.

See more on: Anthropic AI LLC, U.S. Department of Defense

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